“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Antya-līlā

Chapter 20

Relishing the Meaning of the Verses of Instruction

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the «Anubhāṣya», 2026 — draft)

1 Only the fortunate can relish the words that Gauracandra spoke in His divine madness, words mingled with the joy, jealousy, anxiety, humility and anguish that love awakens.[1]

2 Glory, glory to Gauracandra! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura![2]

3 Thus Mahāprabhu lived in Nīlācala, overwhelmed night and day by separation from Kṛṣṇa.

4 Night and day, in the company of these two, Svarūpa and Rāmānanda, He relished songs and verses full of rasa.

5 Many emotions arose in the Lord: joy, grief and anger, humility, anxiety and anguish, eager longing and contentment.

6 In each of these moods He would recite His own verses and relish their meaning with His two friends.

7 Sometimes, in a particular mood, He would recite a verse and stay awake all night relishing it.

8 In joy the Lord said, “Listen, Svarūpa and Rāmarāya! In the age of Kali the congregational chanting of the holy name is the supreme means.

9 In the age of Kali, Kṛṣṇa is worshipped by the sacrifice of *saṅkīrtana*. One who worships Him so is truly intelligent and attains Kṛṣṇa’s feet.”

10 “With sacrifices in which congregational chanting predominates, the wise worship the Lord who ever sings of Kṛṣṇa and whose lustre is not dark. He is always surrounded by His intimate companions (*aṅga*), His devotees (*upāṅga*), His weapons and His associates (*pārṣada*).” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.5.32)[3]

11 “Through the congregational chanting of the holy name all unwanted things (*anartha*) are destroyed, every good fortune dawns, and the joy of love for Kṛṣṇa awakens.”[4]

12 “The chanting of Śrī Kṛṣṇa’s name cleanses the mirror of the heart and puts out the great forest fire of material existence. It spreads the moonlight that opens the white lotus of the soul’s highest good; it is the very life of the bride of divine knowledge. It swells the ocean of bliss, gives at every step a taste of the full nectar, and bathes and cools the whole self. May the supreme chanting of Śrī Kṛṣṇa’s name be ever victorious!” (Śikṣāṣṭaka, 1)[5]

13–14 “Through *saṅkīrtana* sin and material existence are destroyed, the heart is purified, and all the practices of devotion awaken. Love for Kṛṣṇa awakens, and one tastes the nectar of that love. One attains Kṛṣṇa and is immersed in the nectarean ocean of His service.”

15 Then dejection and humility arose in Him, and He recited another verse of His own — a verse whose meaning, once heard, dispels all sorrow and

grief.

16 “O Lord, You have revealed many names, and in them You have invested all Your own potencies. You have fixed no time for remembering them. Such is Your mercy, yet such is my misfortune that no attachment for them has arisen in me.” (Śikṣāṣṭaka, 2)[6]

17 “Different people have desires of many kinds, so in Your mercy You have made known many names.

18 Whether eating or lying down, wherever one may be, one can chant the name. There are no rules of time or place, and through the name all perfection comes.

19 In each of the names You have invested all Your potency. But such is my misfortune: I have no attachment for the name!”

20 “Svarūpa and Rāmarāya, hear the verse that tells how one should chant the name so that love is born.”

21 “Lower than a blade of grass, more tolerant than a tree, seeking no honour and offering honour to others, one should always sing the glories of Hari.” (Śikṣāṣṭaka, 3)[7]

22 “Though he is exalted, a Vaiṣṇava considers himself lower than grass, and like a tree he shows tolerance in two ways.

23 When a tree is cut down it says nothing, and even when it is drying up and dying it asks no one for water.

24 It gives its wealth to whoever asks anything of it; it endures heat and rain, yet shelters others.

25 Though exalted, a Vaiṣṇava should be free from pride. He should honour every living being, knowing it to be the dwelling of Kṛṣṇa.

26 Whoever chants Kṛṣṇa's name in this spirit awakens love for the feet of Śrī Kṛṣṇa."

27 As He spoke, the Lord's humility grew, and He began to beg Kṛṣṇa for pure devotion (*śuddha-bhakti*).

28 Such is the nature of love: one who is truly touched by love thinks, "I have not even a trace of devotion to Kṛṣṇa."

29 "O Lord of the universe, I desire neither wealth, nor followers, nor beautiful poetry. Birth after birth, may I have causeless devotion to You, my Lord." (Śikṣāṣṭaka, 4)[89]

30 "I do not beg for wealth, for followers or for beautiful poetry. O Kṛṣṇa, be merciful and give me pure devotion!"

31 In great humility He again begged for the gift of devotion in servitude, thinking of Himself as an ordinary soul caught in worldly existence.

32 "O son of Nanda, I am Your servant, yet I have fallen into the terrible ocean of material existence. Be merciful and consider me a speck of dust at Your lotus feet." (Śikṣāṣṭaka, 5)[10]

33 "I am Your eternal servant, but I forgot You and fell into the ocean of material existence, bound by *māyā*.

34 Be merciful and make me like a speck of dust at Your feet, so that as Your servant I may serve You."

35 Again intense longing and humility arose in Him, and He begged Kṛṣṇa that He might chant the holy name with love.

36 “When, as I chant Your name, will my eyes overflow with streaming tears, my voice falter and choke, and my body be covered with thrills of joy?” (Śikṣāṣṭaka, 6)[11]

37 “Without the wealth of love, life is poor and futile! Make me Your servant and give me the wealth of love as my wages!”

38 Absorbed in another rasa, He felt the full force of separation, and in anxiety, dejection and humility He began to speak words of divine madness.[12]

39 “In separation from Govinda, a moment seems to Me an age, My eyes pour tears like the rains, and the whole world seems empty.” (Śikṣāṣṭaka, 7)[13]

40 “In My anxiety the day will not pass; a moment has become like an age! Like clouds in the rainy season, My eyes rain tears!

41 In separation from Govinda the three worlds have become empty! I burn as in a slow fire of husks, and yet life does not leave Me.

42 Kṛṣṇa has become indifferent to test Me, and all My friends say, ‘Ignore Kṛṣṇa.’”

43 As these thoughts arose, the very nature of spontaneous love dawned in Rādhā’s pure heart.

44 Jealousy, eagerness, humility, boldness and entreaty — all these emotions arose at once.[14]

45 These emotions unsettled Rādhā's mind, and before Her friends She spoke a bold verse.

46 In that same mood the Lord recited that verse, and as He recited it He Himself became like Her.

47 "Let Him embrace Me, this maidservant devoted to His feet, and make Me His own, or break My heart by not appearing before Me. Let that unrestrained lover (*lampaṭa*) do with Me whatever He likes — He alone is the Lord of My life, and no one else." (Śikṣāṣṭaka, 8)[15]

48 "I am the maidservant of Kṛṣṇa's feet, and He is the very abode of rasa and joy. He may embrace Me and make Me His own, or He may not let Me see Him and so wear away My body and mind — still He is the Lord of My life.

49 O friend, hear the resolve of My heart. Whether He shows Me love or kills Me with pain, Kṛṣṇa — and no one else — is the Lord of My life.

50 Sometimes He leaves the other women, and His body and mind are under My control. Making My good fortune plain, He pains them all by sporting with Me before their eyes.

51 Or else, libertine, cheat, brazen and deceitful as He is, He takes other women with Him and sports with them before My eyes just to pain My heart — still He is the Lord of My life.

52 I do not count My own pain; I desire only His happiness. His happiness is My whole aim. If by giving Me pain He finds great happiness, that pain is My greatest happiness.

53 If Kṛṣṇa longs for a certain woman, drawn by her beauty, and grows sad because He cannot meet her, I fall at her feet, take her by the hand and

bring her to Him, and by arranging their pastimes I make Him happy.

54 When a beloved is angry with Kṛṣṇa, He is pleased and takes joy in her scolding and rebukes. When, as is fitting, she shows loving pique (*māna*), it gives Him delight, and at a little coaxing she lets it go.

55 Why does a woman live who does not know Kṛṣṇa's heart and yet is bitterly angry with Him? She counts her own happiness as gain — may a thunderbolt fall on her head! We desire only Kṛṣṇa's satisfaction.[16]

56 If a gopī who is hostile to Me pleases Kṛṣṇa, and Kṛṣṇa longs for her company, I will go to her house and serve her as her maidservant. Then My happiness overflows.

57 The wife of a leprous *brāhmaṇa*, the crest jewel of chaste wives, served a prostitute for her husband's sake. She stopped the course of the sun, brought her dead husband back to life, and pleased the three principal deities.[17]

58 Kṛṣṇa is My life; Kṛṣṇa is the treasure of My life; Kṛṣṇa is the very life of My life. I hold Him upon My heart and make Him happy by serving Him — this is My constant meditation.

59 My happiness lies in serving Him; Kṛṣṇa's happiness lies in union with Me. Therefore I offer Him My body. Kṛṣṇa treats Me as His beloved and calls Me the queen of His life, but I think of Myself as His maidservant.

60 The fullness of joy in serving the beloved is sweeter even than union. The goddess Lakṣmī is witness to this: though she dwells on Nārāyaṇa's heart, she longs to serve His feet, and she serves Him thinking of herself as His maidservant."

61 Śrī Gaura Rāya relished these words of Rādhā, which bear the marks of pure love. His mind grew unsteady with emotion, sāttvika symptoms pervaded His body, and He could no longer hold His mind and body still.[18]

62 In pure love for the Lord of Vraja there is no trace of desire for one's own happiness: it is like gold from the river Jambū. To make this love known to the world, the Lord composed this verse and set out its meaning at length in songs.[1920]

63 Thus, absorbed in ecstatic emotion, Mahāprabhu recited some verses and spoke words of divine madness.

64 Earlier He had composed these eight verses to instruct the people; now He Himself relished them.

65 Whoever reads or hears the Lord's *Śikṣāṣṭaka* verses will find his loving devotion to Kṛṣṇa growing day by day.

66 Though the Lord is as deep as millions of oceans, He grows restless when the moon of His many emotions rises.[21]

67–68 Whatever verses of Jayadeva, of the *Bhāgavata*, of Rāmānanda Rāya's drama and of the *Karṇāmṛta* suited each mood, He would recite in that mood and relish, absorbed in that emotion.

69 For twelve years He was in this state night and day, relishing the rasa of Kṛṣṇa with His two friends.

70 Even Ananta Himself, describing with His thousand mouths the rasa of all these pastimes, cannot reach their end.

71 How can a soul of small intelligence describe them? I touch just one particle of them, to purify myself.

72 His actions and His words of divine madness have no limit; to describe them all would make the book enormous.[22]

73 Of the pastimes that Vṛndāvana dāsa had described before me, I have given only a summary.[23]

74 I have briefly told the "remainder" that he left untold, and even so the book has grown, because the pastimes are so many.

75 Therefore I cannot describe all those pastimes; offering my obeisances to them, I have brought my account to a close.

76 What little I have told is only an indication of the way; by following it one can relish those pastimes.

77 I cannot understand the Lord's profound pastimes; my intellect cannot enter them, and so I cannot describe them.[24]

78 Bowing at the feet of all the Vaiṣṇavas who hear this, I bring to a close my description of Śrī Caitanya's deeds.

79 The sky is unlimited, yet each bird in it flies only as high as its strength allows.[25]

80 So too Mahāprabhu's pastimes have no shore on either side. Who, being only a *jīva*, can describe them fully?

81 I have described as much as my intelligence could reach — as if I had touched a single drop in the midst of the ocean.

82 Vṛndāvana dāsa, the vessel of Nityānanda's mercy, is the original Vyāsa (*ādi-vyāsa*) of Caitanya's pastimes.[26]

83 Although the storehouse of all the pastimes lay before him, he described only a little and left the rest.

84 Even the little I have described I have told only in brief — things he could not write out in full, though he did record them.

85 Here and there in the *Caitanya-maṅgala* he has written of them. Hear those words: they are the supreme evidence.[27]

86 I have told it in brief, for it cannot be told in full. Vedavyāsa will describe it in detail.

87 He has written this here and there in the *Caitanya-maṅgala*, and he speaks the truth: afterwards Vyāsa described these pastimes.[2829]

88 The nectar-ocean of Caitanya's pastimes is like the Ocean of Milk. He filled his pitcher as his thirst required and drank.

89 He gave me a little of the nectar left in his pitcher, and that little filled me and quenched my thirst.[30]

90–91 I am a very tiny soul, like the little *rāṅgā-ṭuni* bird. As that bird, when thirsty, drinks the water of the ocean, so I have touched a single drop of the pastimes. By this example know how vast the Lord's pastimes are.[31]

92 To think "I am writing" is a false notion: my body is like a wooden puppet.[32]

93 I am old and infirm, blind and deaf; my hands shake, and my mind and intelligence are not steady.[33]

94 Many diseases have seized me; I can neither walk nor sit. Tormented by the pain of five ailments, day and night I am all but dying.

95 I have already confessed this earlier in the book. Still I write — hear the reason for it.

96–98 Śrī Govinda, Śrī Caitanya, Śrī Nityānanda, Śrī Advaita, the devotees and the revered listeners; Śrī Svarūpa, Śrī Rūpa, Śrī Sanātana; Śrī Raghunātha dāsa, my guru, and the feet of Śrī Jīva — by the mercy of the feet of all these I am made to write. And there is One more: He shows me exceptional mercy.[34]

99 Śrī Madana-Gopāla, by His order, makes me write. It is not fitting to say this, yet I cannot keep silent.

100 If I did not say it, I would be guilty of ingratitude. Though I speak as if out of pride, O listeners, do not be angry.

101 I have bowed down to the dust of the feet of you all, and by this the little I have written of Caitanya's pastimes came to be.[35]

102 Now I shall recapitulate the pastimes of the Antya-līlā: by recapitulating (*anuvāda*) I relish the pastimes again.[36]

103 In the first chapter: Rūpa's second meeting with the Lord, and how the Lord heard of his plan for the two plays.

104 In it a dog came with Śivānanda, and the Lord, making it say "Kṛṣṇa", liberated it.

105 In the second: the lesson the Lord gave Choṭa Haridāsa, and Śivānanda's wonderful vision.

106 In the third: the mighty glory of Haridāsa, and Dāmodara Paṇḍita's rebuke to the Lord.

107 By giving the holy name, the Lord delivered the universe, and Haridāsa established the glory of the name.

108 In the fourth: Śrī Sanātana's second meeting with the Lord, who saved him from giving up his body.

109 In the blazing sun of the month of Jyaiṣṭha the Lord tested him; then, investing him with power, He sent him back to Vṛndāvana.

110 In the fifth: the Lord's mercy to Pradyumna Miśra, whom He sent to hear talks of Kṛṣṇa from Rāmānanda Rāya.

111 In it: the rejection of a "Bengali" poet's play, and how Svarūpa Gosāñi established the glory of the Deity (*vigraha*).

112 In the sixth: Raghunātha dāsa met the Lord, and by Nityānanda's order he held the festival of flat rice (*ciḍā*).

113 The Lord entrusted him to Svarūpa Dāmodara and gave him the *śilā* from Govardhana and the *guñjā* garland.

114 In the seventh chapter: the meeting with Vallabha Bhaṭṭa, whose pride the Lord broke in various ways.

115 In the eighth: the arrival of Rāmacandra Purī, for fear of whom the Lord reduced His meals.

116 In the ninth: the release of Gopīnātha Paṭṭanāyaka; and the people of the three worlds received the Lord's *darśana*.

117 In the tenth I told how the Lord relished what the devotees gave Him, and how Rāghava Paṇḍita packed his bags (*jhāli*).

118 There the Lord tested Govinda, and there too is the description of the dance in a circle (*parimuṇḍā-nṛtya*).

119 In the eleventh: the departure of Haridāsa Ṭhākura, in which Gaura Bhagavān showed His affection for His devotees.

120 In the twelfth: Jagadānanda's breaking of the pitcher of oil, and Nityānanda's punishment of Śivānanda.

121 In the thirteenth: Jagadānanda went to Mathurā and came back, and Mahāprabhu heard the song of a *devadāsī*.

122 There too is the meeting with Raghunātha Bhaṭṭācārya, whom the Lord in His mercy sent to Vṛndāvana.

123 In the fourteenth: the beginning of the divine madness, when the Lord's "body" was here and His "mind" had gone to Vṛndāvana.

124 In it: the Lord's fall at the Siṁha-dvāra, the loosening of His joints, and the rise of ecstatic symptoms (*anubhāva*).

125 Seeing Caṭaka-parvata, the Lord ran towards it; and the chapter describes some of His ecstatic ravings (*pralāpa*).

126 In the fifteenth chapter: the pastimes in the garden, which the Lord entered, taking it for Vṛndāvana.

127 In it: the attraction of the Lord's five senses, and His search for Kṛṣṇa in the *rāsa* dance.

128 In the sixteenth the Lord showed mercy to Kālidāsa and revealed the fruit of eating the remnants of Vaiṣṇavas.

129 The Lord had Śivānanda's young son compose a verse, and the door-keeper of the Siṁha-dvāra showed Kṛṣṇa to the Lord.

130 There He described the glory of *mahā-prasāda* and relished the verse on the fruit of the nectar of Kṛṣṇa's lips.

131 In the seventeenth: the Lord's fall among the cows, and the ecstatic symptom (*anubhāva*) in which His body took the form of a tortoise.

132 The qualities of Kṛṣṇa's sound drew the Lord's mind, and in ecstasy He explained the meaning of the verse *kā stry aṅga te*.

133 In a mingling of emotions (*bhāva-śābalya*) He again spoke in ecstatic raving, and He explained the meaning of a verse of the *Karṇāmṛta*.

134 In the eighteenth chapter: the Lord's fall into the ocean, and there His vision of the water-play of Kṛṣṇa and the gopīs.

135 There too He saw Kṛṣṇa's meal in the forest. A fisherman pulled Him out, and the Lord came back to His residence.

136 In the nineteenth: the Lord's rubbing His face against the wall, and His ravings as separation from Kṛṣṇa welled up within Him.

137 There too: His wandering in a flower garden on a spring night, and His explanation of the verse on Kṛṣṇa's fragrance.

138 In the twentieth chapter: reciting His own *Śikṣāṣṭaka*, the Lord, absorbed in love, relished its meaning.

139 He had spoken the *Śikṣāṣṭaka* to teach the devotees, and now He relished the meaning of those eight verses once more.

140 I have told the substance of the principal pastimes; by recapitulation (*anuvāda*) the contents of the book are remembered.[37]

141 Each chapter has topics of many kinds. I have told only the principal ones, for the story cannot be told at length.[38]

142–143 Śrī Madana-mohana with Śrī Rādhā, the feet of Śrī Govinda with Śrī Rādhā, and beautiful Śrī Gopīnātha with Śrī Rādhā — these three Deities are the Lords of the Gauḍīyas.[39]

144–146 Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, the glorious Nityānanda, Śrī Advaita Ācārya and the devotees of Śrī Gaura; Śrī Svarūpa, Śrī Rūpa, Śrī Sanātana; Śrī Raghunātha, my guru, and the feet of Śrī Jīva — I hold the feet of all these on my head, for from them comes the fulfilment of every desire.[40]

147 The mercy of the feet of all of them is the teacher (*upādhyāyī*), and the author's speech is her pupil, whom she makes dance in many ways.[41][42]

148 Seeing the pupil's weariness, the teacher stopped the dance. When "mercy" does not make her dance, "speech" sits still.

149 Unskilled speech does not know how to dance by herself: she danced as much as she was made to dance, and then she rested.

150 I bow down at the feet of all my listeners, the mercy of whose feet is the cause of all good.[43]

151 Whoever hears the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta* — I wash his feet and drink that water.

152 I make the dust of my listeners' feet the ornament of my head. You have drunk this nectar, and my labour has borne fruit.

153 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.[44]

154 This nectarean account of the life of Śrīla Caitanya, who is Viṣṇu Himself, bestows all good and destroys all evil. At the spotless lotus feet of whoever relishes it with faith I become a bee, and drink to the full the rasa that overflows with the intoxicating honey of prema.[4546]

155 For the satisfaction of Śrīman Madana-Gopāla and Govinda-deva, may this *Caitanya-caritāmṛta* be offered to Śrī Caitanya.[47]

156 The lotus feet of Giridhara fill the world with their fragrance, and with their own rasa they intoxicate the bees who know rasa. What *rasika* could ever bear to leave them?[48]

157 The dust of the lotus feet of my Mistress, Śrī Rādhikā, is the whole wealth of my life, and by its power I surrender to Śrī Śrīla Govinda, the dust of whose lotus feet is dearer to Her than life and is Her all in all.[49]

158 In the Śaka year 1537, in the month of Jyaiṣṭha, in Vṛndāvana, on a Sunday, the fifth day of the dark fortnight, this book was completed.[5051]

Notes

1. *Anubhāṣya*: the fortunate are the great souls who have gained the wealth of prema. Heading in the edition: only a devotee in whom prema has awakened

can follow the feeling of separation the Lord experienced. ↩

2. The same verse as Madhya 4.2 (and Antya 3.2, 10.2); translation as there. ↩
3. The same verse as Ādi 3.51 (and Madhya 20.340); translation as there. ↩
4. Heading in the edition: the fruit of nāmābhāsa free from offences is the destruction of all anarthas; then the fruit of the pure name — the highest good and the awakening of love for Kṛṣṇa. ↩
5. *Anubhāṣya*: the saṅkīrtana of Śrī Kṛṣṇa cleanses the mirror of the mind, puts out the great forest fire of worldly existence, spreads moonlight for the white lilies of the highest good, keeps alive the bride of knowledge, swells the ocean of bliss — prema — gives at every moment a taste of the full nectar and bathes the whole being; it is one without a second and stands above all. Heading in the edition: the *Śrī Śikṣāṣṭaka*, which came from the Lord's holy mouth — the essence of the *Bhāgavatam*; the verse is cited in the *Padyāvalī* (10). ↩
6. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Your name alone brings every good to the jīvas, and so You have revealed many names — "Kṛṣṇa", "Govinda" and others; yet my misfortune — offences to the name (nāmāparādha) — does not let attachment arise in me even for this easily attained name. Heading in the edition: why the practice of the name is so easy — Kṛṣṇa's great generosity; and why a jīva caught in offences cannot utter the pure name; the verse is cited in the *Padyāvalī* (19). ↩
7. The same verse as Ādi 17.31 (and Antya 6.239; the edition reads *taror iva*, as there); translation as there. Heading in the edition: the path of practising the name for the sake of prema — the prohibition of identifying oneself with the body (the root of all offences) and the injunction to chant without cease; the verse is cited in the *Padyāvalī* (20). ↩
8. *Sundarīṁ kavitām*, "beautiful poetry": so the *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya* and the *Anubhāṣya* take the words; other translations take *sundarī* as "a beautiful woman." ↩
9. *Anubhāṣya*: neither wealth, nor followers, nor beautiful poetry — nothing that serves religiosity, wealth and pleasure and is deceitful by nature; I ask neither for enjoyment nor for liberation, only for causeless, unbroken, pure devotion to You, Adhokṣaja. Heading in the edition: the one desire of the sincere practitioner — eternal and pure devotion; the verse is cited in the *Padyāvalī* (85). ↩
10. Heading in the edition: the practitioner, in his true self, begs mercy of Adhokṣaja, who enjoys spiritual pastimes; the verse is cited in the *Padyāvalī* (13). ↩

11. Heading in the edition: the outward signs of perfection (sādhya-bhakti); the verse is cited in the *Padyāvalī* (84). ↩
12. *Rasāntarāveśa* — absorption in another rasa: from the prayers of a servant (31–37) the Lord passes to the feelings of Śrī Rādhā in separation (39–60). Heading in the edition: the inner signs of perfection — worship rooted in transcendental separation (vipralambha) from Kṛṣṇa. ↩
13. Heading in the edition: the seventh verse of the *Śikṣāṣṭaka*, cited in the *Padyāvalī* (327). ↩
14. Heading in the edition: the Lord, filled with the feeling of Śrī Rādhā, the crown of those wholly in Kṛṣṇa's power. ↩
15. *Anubhāṣya*: *pinaṣṭu* — "may He make His own"; *lampaṭa* — absorbed in the joy of pleasing His own senses: "let Him do as He pleases, or sport with other beloveds." Heading in the edition: the steadfastness (niṣṭhā) of perfection — exclusive dependence on Kṛṣṇa; the verse is cited in the *Padyāvalī* (134). ↩
16. *Anubhāṣya*: a devotee who thinks he has reached the goal in his own happiness ruins himself — he becomes a sahajiyā who seeks worldly enjoyment. Heading in the edition: reproach of one who longs for enjoyment (sambhoga) with Kṛṣṇa. ↩
17. *Anubhāṣya*: the story is told in the *Āditya*, *Mārkaṇḍeya* (15.29) and *Padma Purāṇas*. The leprous husband of the chaste wife unknowingly disturbed the samādhi of the sage Māṇḍavya and was cursed to die at sunrise; she vowed not to let the sun rise, and Brahmā, Viṣṇu and Śiva, pleased with her fidelity, healed her husband and gave him new life. The point: only such selfless fidelity — the desire for happiness in service alone — befits pure devotees. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: firm fidelity to Kṛṣṇa is the highest dharma of the jīva, born of śṛṅgāra-rasa. ↩
18. Heading in the edition: the Lord, filled with the feeling of Śrī Rādhā, relishes pure love (kevala-prema). ↩
19. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads *vrajeśvara-śuddha-prema*, "pure love for the Lord of Vraja," which is translated here; it notes the reading of another manuscript, *vrajera viśuddha prema*, "the pure love of Vraja"; the *Anubhāṣya* also cites the reading *se prema*, "that love." In the edition — *jāmbunada* (short *u*). ↩
20. Heading in the edition: in the desire to please Kṛṣṇa's senses there is no desire to please one's own; the supremely generous Gaura, through the *Śikṣāṣṭaka*, gives the jīvas the essence of the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* — sambandha, abhidheya and prayojana. ↩

21. Heading in the edition: for all His matchless depth, the Lord loses His composure in mahābhāva — the divine madness born of separation — as the ocean heaves at the rising of the full moon. ↩
22. Heading in the edition: fearing to make the book too long, the author stops describing the Lord's manifestations of love. ↩
23. Heading in the edition: what is described in detail in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata* is described briefly in this book, and what is described briefly there is described here in detail. ↩
24. Heading in the edition: though the author is guided by the will of Śrī Caitanya Himself, he speaks in humility. ↩
25. *Anubhāṣya*: compare *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.18.23 — as birds fly in the sky as far as their strength allows, so the wise describe the ways of Viṣṇu as far as they are able. Heading in the edition: the ocean of Gaura's pastimes is beyond this world and beyond the senses (adhokṣaja); a conditioned soul cannot touch it, and the author, thinking himself a jīva, in deep humility only tries to touch a drop of it. ↩
26. *Anubhāṣya*: the later pure ācāryas who described Gaura's pastimes after him are, as his non-different parts, also called "Vyāsa" (cf. 86–87). Heading in the edition: the greatness of Ṭhākura Vṛndāvana, and Gaura's pastimes. ↩
27. *Caitanya-maṅgala* is the original title of the *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (cf. Ādi 8.33–35). Heading in the edition: the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, the definitive book on Viṣṇu, the Vaiṣṇavas and pure devotion to Viṣṇu, is the highest evidence (*pramāṇa*). ↩
28. So in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: *karilā varṇane*, "described"; other manuscripts read *karibena varṇane*, "will describe". *Āge* here means "afterwards", not "before": verse 86 too speaks of Vyāsa describing these pastimes in the future. On the *Caitanya-maṅgala* see the note to 85. ↩
29. *Anubhāṣya*: on the variant reading *āge vyāsa karibena varṇane*, "Vyāsa will describe them in the future", these and similar words of the *Caitanya-bhāgavata* refer to the later pure Vaiṣṇava ācāryas, headed by Kavirāja Gosvāmī, who described Gaura's pastimes; following the "original Vyāsa" Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura, such ācāryas are also called "Vyāsa" (on 82). ↩
30. Heading in the edition (before 88): the author, free of pride and honouring others, regards himself as one who eats the remnants of Ṭhākura Vṛndāvana. ↩
31. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the *rāṅgā-ṭuni* is the tiny *ṭunṭuni* bird (the Bengali tailorbird). Heading in the edition: words of humility once more. ↩
32. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: it is vain to think that I wrote this book; the Lord and His devotees are making me write it. Heading in the edition: unlike worldly

poets and men of letters, the author — the emperor of transcendental poets — is not deluded by false ego: he depends wholly on Kṛṣṇa and is guided by Caitanya's will. ↩

33. Heading in the edition: regarding himself as a mere instrument, the author describes his unfitness and speaks in humility. ↩
34. *Anubhāṣya*: Śrī Raghunātha dāsa is the guru who taught the author bhajana, the best of the followers of Śrī Rūpa (see 145; the succession of Śrī Rūpa's followers is given at the beginning of the *Anubhāṣya* to Ādi 1). Heading in the edition: the author names those whom he worships; before 98 — the author proclaims his good fortune, the mercy of Madana-mohana. ↩
35. Heading in the edition: obeisance to the listeners. ↩
36. In the Bengali, *anuvāda* ("recapitulation") rhymes with *āsvāda* ("relish"). Heading in the edition: following Vyāsa's example in the *Bhāgavatam*, the author recapitulates the Antya-līlā, briefly listing its chapters. ↩
37. Heading in the edition: only recapitulation (*anuvāda*) — review or retelling — awakens the memory of the pastimes. ↩
38. Heading in the edition: fearing excessive length, the author has described only the principal events. ↩
39. Heading in the edition: the author's worshipful Deities, the Lords of the Gauḍīyas who preside over *sambandha*, *abhidheya* and *prayojana* — Śrī Rādhā-Madana-mohana, Govinda and Gopīnātha. ↩
40. *Anubhāṣya*: Śrī Raghunātha dāsa is the guru who taught the author bhajana (see 97). Heading in the edition: obeisance to Gaura, who is the Pañca-tattva; before 145 — the author, who follows the path of rāga, bows to the gurus, embodiments of Gaura's potency; before 146 — only obeisance to them leads to the desired goal. ↩
41. So in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: *tāra vāṇī*, "his speech" — the author speaks of himself in the third person, as in the closing lines of the chapters; *tāra* is written without the *candrabindu*, as one speaks of oneself (of those he honours the author writes *tāṅra*, 83, 89), and "their" would be *sabāra*. Other manuscripts read *mora vāṇī*, "my speech" (cited in the *Anubhāṣya* as a variant). ↩
42. *Anubhāṣya*: *upādhyāyī* — one to whom pupils come to learn (*Manu-smṛti* 2.141), here a teacher of the arts (*kalā-vidyā*). Heading in the edition: only by following the mercy of Nityānanda, which is full of Caitanya (consciousness), can speech glorify Caitanya's pastimes. ↩
43. Heading in the edition: obeisance to the listeners and a prayer for their mercy. ↩

44. The same verse as Ādi 1.110 (and Antya 19.112), the refrain that closes the chapters; translation as there. ↩
45. *Tad-* (“his”) answers *yaḥ* (“whoever”), and *so ’yam* (“this very one”) is the author himself; so the verse is read by the heading in the edition — “the author’s words of humility” (cf. 151–152, where the author drinks the water that has washed the listener’s feet). The stage-A translation followed another reading: “whoever relishes it with faith becomes a bee at His spotless lotus feet”. ↩
46. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: at the spotless lotus feet of one who with faith relishes this account, which bestows good and destroys all evil, this writer becomes a bee and relishes to the full the rasa filled with the intoxicating honey of prema. ↩
47. The same verse as Madhya 25.275; translation as there. Heading in the edition: for Kṛṣṇa’s pleasure the author offers the nectar of this book to Śrī Caitanya. ↩
48. So in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the *Anubhāṣya*: *rasajña-rolambam*, “bees who know rasa” — according to the *Anubhāṣya*, the *rasika* devotees intoxicated by the sweet rasa, *śṛṅgāra*. Other manuscripts read *rasikālambam*, “the shelter of the *rasikas*”. According to the *Anubhāṣya* (on verse 158), verses 156–158 are not found in many manuscripts. Heading in the edition: the lotus feet of Kṛṣṇa alone are the transcendental, boundless reservoir of rasa. ↩
49. Translated according to the original and the *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: “By the power of the dust of the lotus feet of her who is the all-in-all of my life, and meditating on the dust of the lotus feet that is dearer than life and the all-in-all to my Mistress Śrīmatī Rādhikā, I surrender to Śrī Śrī Govinda-deva.” Heading in the edition: surrender to Śrī Rādhā-Govinda, the author’s own worshipful Deity. ↩
50. *Sindhu* (ocean) = 7, *agni* (fire) = 3, *bāṇa* (arrow) = 5, *indu* (moon) = 1. *Anubhāṣya*: by the rule that the digits run from right to left — Śaka 1537 (A.D. 1615). Heading in the edition: the time of the book’s completion. ↩
51. In the edition this verse is unnumbered; the number 158 is from the *Anubhāṣya*. Here the edition gives the colophon: “Thus ends the twentieth chapter of the Antya-khaṇḍa of the *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, called Relishing the Meaning of the Verses of Instruction”, and the words: “Thus the Antya-līlā is completed.” ↩